

## DR. SAMANEH KHAEF

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I am a Human geographer with extensive teaching experience across Bachelor's and Master's courses in human geography, GIS, spatial analysis, migration, and research methods, as well as experience supervising students at both levels (592 hours of teaching since 2018). My research focuses on migration and integration, education and labour-market pathways, residential mobility, housing and neighbourhoods, with particular attention to regional and geographical inequalities and how spatial and urban–rural contexts shape life-course trajectories and integration outcomes.

### CURRENT POSITION

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**2024–present** — Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

#### Current projects:

- Embedded Lives: Contextual Effects on Life Course Trajectories (2026–2029)
- Language and Life-Course: An Exploration of the Swedish-for-Immigrants Program, 1990–2022 (2024–2027). [Link](#)
- How Do Perceptions of the City Inform Neighbourhood Selection and Housing Search? A Comparison of Second-Generation Migrants and Natives in Uppsala (2023–2026). [Link](#)

#### Completed project:

- The Neighbourhood Revisited: Spatial Polarization and Social Cohesion in Contemporary Sweden (2019–2024). [Link](#)

### EDUCATION

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**2024** — PhD, Human Geography, Stockholm University

- Thesis: Migration Trajectories and Education: Measurement, Spatial Patterns, and Integration Pathways of Adult Migrants

<https://su.diva-portal.org/smash/get/diva2:1842515/FULLTEXT01.pdf>

**2013** — MSc, Urban Planning and Management (with application of GIS), University of Twente, Netherlands

- Thesis: Examining Quality of Life through a Gendered Lens in Birmingham

**2011** — MSc, Urban and Regional Planning, University of Tehran, Iran — with great distinction

- Thesis: Exploring Dimensions of Quality of Life in a Deteriorated Neighbourhood in Tehran Metropolitan City

**2009** — Bachelor of Urban Studies, University of Tehran, Iran — with great distinction

- Final project: Assessing Smart Growth Indicators in Planning Development, Tehran

### RESEARCH INTERESTS & METHODS

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- Migration, education, labour-market integration, residential choice and mobility
- Neighbourhoods, housing, segregation, spatial polarization and social cohesion
- Integration across generations and across the urban–rural hierarchy
- Kinship, social ties, neighbourhood mobility and residential pathways
- School and preschool segregation and educational pathways
- Gender, migration and geographical context
- Quantitative methods, semi-structured interviews and social surveying
- Swedish register data; Stata, SPSS, R/RStudio, Microsoft Excel and ArcGIS

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**2024–present** — Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

**2018–2024** — PhD Student, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

**2017** — Visiting Scientist, Migration, Demography and Security Unit, European Commission Joint Research Centre, Ispra, Italy

- Project: School and residential segregation in Italian metropolitan areas.

**2014–2017** — Senior Planner, Arse Planning Consultancy Firm, Tehran, Iran

- Neighbourhood composition and school segregation across municipalities in Tehran.
- Mapping inequality: spatial variation in school demographics and socioeconomic composition.
- Multiculturalism, migration and ethnic diversity.
- Housing-market discrimination against Afghan migrants in Iran.

**2013–2014** — Senior Planner, Parhoss Urban Planning Consultancy Office, Tehran, Iran

- Educational inequalities and school accessibility in deprived neighbourhoods.
- Integrated planning for an inclusive society in southern Iran.
- Segregation and fragmented development in Tehran metropolitan area.

**2009–2011** — Junior Planner, Design, Architecture, Environment, Urban Planning Consultancy Company, Tehran, Iran

**2008–2009** — Planner Assistant, Novinsaz Kelar Architecture and Planning Company, Tehran, Iran

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS & DISSERTATION

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**Khaef, S.**, (2026). Enrolment and patterns of participation in Swedish for immigrants (SFI): timing, duration, and selectivity. *Genus*, 82, 11, [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.**, (2025). Unravelling integration: Educational enrolment pathways of adult refugees in Sweden. *Population*, 80 (2), [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.**, (2024a). Migration Trajectories and Education: Measurement, Spatial Patterns, and Integration Pathways of Adult Migrants. Stockholm University, Faculty of Social Sciences, Department of Human Geography. [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.**, Haandrikman, K. (2024b). The Initial Residential Patterns of Immigrants Across the Urban Hierarchy in Sweden: The Role of Educational Attainment. *Tijdschrift Voor Economische En Sociale Geografie*, [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.**, (2022). Registration of Immigrants' Educational Attainment in Sweden: An Analysis of Sources and Time to Registration. *Genus* 78, 16 (2022). [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.**, Zebardast, E. (2016). Assessing Quality of Life Dimensions in Deteriorated Inner Areas: A case from Javadieh Neighbourhood in Tehran Metropolis. *Social Indicator Research*. 127, 761–775. [DOI](#)

**Khaef, S.** (2013). Perception of quality of life through a gendered lens. a case from the city of Birmingham. University of Twente, Faculty of Geo-Information Science and Earth

## WORKING & UNDER-REVISION PAPERS

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**Khaef, S.**, (2026a). Uneven returns to language training participation: regional variation in migrants' first employment entry in Sweden

**Khaef, S.**, Malmberg, B. (2026b). Life-Course Trajectories and Tenure Type Contexts: Spatial Assimilation among Migrants in Sweden

**Khaef, S.**, (2026c). Family ties and neighbourhood attainment: kin proximity, kin's neighbourhood poverty, and residential mobility in Sweden

Forsberg, S., **Khaef, S.**, (2026d). Residential reasoning and stigmatisation: How place labels and perceived unsafety shape housing search

Wimark, T., **Khaef, S.**, Frisch, F. (2026e). From Private to Corporate: Privatisation and financialization in the Swedish housing market. Under revision

## **POLICY BRIEF and DISCUSSION**

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**Khaef, S.** (2026). "Uneven employment benefits of language training: regional variation in migrants' first employment entry in Sweden". Population Europé. [Population Europe – Policy Insight](#)

**Khaef, S.** (2025). "Sweden's migration rules 'not really in favor of those with high education", Interviewed by Local Sweden based on my expertise on migration, high education. Link to interview: [Read the interview at The Local](#)

**Khaef, S.** (2025). "Utbildningens betydelse för invandras integrationsprocess". Magasinet Konkret. [Read the article at Magasinet Konkret](#)

**Khaef, S.**, Migali, S. (2017). The relationship between immigrants' location in Italian cities and schools, JRC, European Commission, internally published

**Khaef, S.** (2016). Gendered Perspective in Planning and Development, Ministry of Road and Urban Development

## **RESEARCH FUNDING & GRANTS**

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- 2025 — Vetenskapsrådet: Embedded Lives: Contextual Effects on Life Course Trajectories — SEK 6,627,591. PI: Bo Malmberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Linn Axelsson and Jutta Kawalerowicz.
- 2024 — Vetenskapsrådet: Språk och livsbana: Svenska för invandrare som inkörsport, 1990–2022 (2024–2027) — SEK 6,754,724. PI: Bo Malmberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Linn Axelsson and Katrin Ahlgren.
- 2022 — Hur påverkar uppfattningar om staden valet av bostadsområde och sökandet av en bostad? — SEK 6,721,356. PI: Sara Forsberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Guilherme Chihaya Da Silva, Benjamin Jarvis.
- 2019 — Alice Wallenbergs: publication and conference participation support.
- 2020 — Carl Mannerfelt Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2022–2023 — Universitetets Donationsstipendier: publication and conference participation support.
- 2023–2024 — Ahlmanns Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2023–2024 — Lagrelius Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2011 — Erasmus Mundus, SALAM scheme: tuition, accommodation, travel and monthly allowance.

## **TEACHING**

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**2018–2026** — Teaching at Stockholm University

### **• Undergraduate:**

GIS and Spatial Analysis I;

Essay on Swedish Geography;

Swedish Geography; Geographical Methods I;

Geographical Information Systems and Cartography;

Geography II;

Intelligence Analysis for Policy and Business (Human Geography);

Geographical Information Analysis II;

Place, Identity and Migration.

### **• Postgraduate:**

Migration and Social Change – A Life Course Perspective;

Advanced Method in Human Geography and Urban and Regional Planning.

## SUPERVISION

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### Master students (successfully completed):

- 2026 Suleman Swala–Integration of migrants to labour market and role of SFI  
2026 Märtha Eriksson–Honor Norms and Social Control in Urban Environments in Stockholm  
2024 Tramosljanin, Vanja– The role of language in social and cultural dimensions of integration.

### Bachelor Students: 2018\_2026 (successfully completed):

- Hibah Rabto– Hur långt är för långt till parken?  
Emma Woxborg Cederborg–Tillgång och tillgänglighet till samhälls nödvändiga verksamheter i Strängnäs kommu  
Björn, Nordvall– An Autoethnographic Reading of Urban Habit and Memory  
Elin, Mattsson–Polycentricity as A Sustainable Spatial Structure?  
Julia, Nordenvall–Utmaningar I Barndeltagandet: När Går Ribban Från Att Vara Målsnöre Till Snubbeltråd?  
Matilda, Karlsson–Analys Om Hantering Av Översvämningsrisk I Planeringsarbetet: En Kvalitativ Fallstudie På Karlstads Kommun  
Philip, Brunzell Hessling–Resenärers Val Av Tåg Till Och Frånflygplatsen

## CONFERENCES & ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENT

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- 2026: International Geographical Union; Nordic Geography Meeting; European Population Conference; International Geographical Union / Royal Geographical Society.
- 2025: Beyond the Registry, Beyond Academia; IMISCOE 22nd Annual Conference; ECSR–Collegio Carlo Alberto–NASP Spring School of Integration Across Generations; Nordregio knowledge sharing.
- 2024: European Association of Population Studies, Edinburgh.
- 2023: Uppdrag landsbygd, Uppsala; Applied Population Geography Research, Lesbos; Stockholm University Demography Unit; EpiDem PhD Conference, Terekov.
- 2022: European Network for Housing Research, Barcelona.
- 2019–2020: Population Geography Conference, Loughborough; Stockholm University Demography Unit; Research Group Studies on Education, Migration and Segregation (EMS), Uppsala University.
- 2018: European Network for Housing Research, Athens.

## GUEST SPEAKER

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- 2024: Guest expert, workshop “Archives as tools for integration and belonging”, Stockholm.

## ACADEMIC SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

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- 2026: Invited participant in EU Horizon project We-ID (Identities – Migration – Democracy), University of Göttingen.
- 2025–present: Affiliated member, Centre for Migration and Integration Research, Stockholm School of Economics. [Link](#)
- 2025–present: Member, Housing, Education, Segregation (BUS), Uppsala University. [Link](#)
- 2025–present: Key member, Education and Social Inequality Standing Committee, IMISCOE.
- 2024–present: PhD Representative in Supervision Meetings.
- 2023: Representative of Social Sciences Faculty Council to the Central PhD Student Council, CDR.
- 2022: Secretary, PhD Council Meeting.
- 2019–present: Key member, IILME Standing Committee, IMISCOE. [Link](#)
- 2018–2020: PhD Representative, ALM (Work Environment, Gender Equality and Equal Conditions), Human Geography Department.
- 2018: Event organizer, Pink Programming.

## PEER REVIEW

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Cities;  
Emotion, Space, and Society;  
Educational Research Review;  
Comparative Migration Studies;  
Humanities & Social Sciences Communications;  
Journal of International Migration and Integration;  
Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies;  
British Journal of Sociology;  
Journal of Housing and the Built Environment.

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & LANGUAGES

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- 2024 — Professional Development 1: Teaching and Learning, 7.5 ECTS, Centre for the Advancement of University Teaching, Stockholm University.
- Pedagogical workshops: Strategies for successful supervision; Exploring AI text generation for teaching and learning; Encouraging student engagement through interactive lectures.
- 2018–2024 — Swedish Language Courses for International Employees, Stockholm University / Folkuniversitetet: Swedish A–D.
- 2023 — Svenska som andraspråk, grundläggande delkurs 2, ABF City, 200 points.
- 2021 — Swedish language private tuition, 15 hours.

## REFEREES

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• **Professor Bo Malmberg:** Professor of Human Geography, Stockholm University | bo.malmberg@humangeo.su.se | +46 08-16 48 53

PI of two ongoing projects, main PhD supervisor;

• **Associate senior lecturer, Sara Forsberg:** Human Geography, Uppsala University | sara.forsberg@kultgeog.uu.se | +46 70 425 03 56

PI of one ongoing project, co-applicant in my VR application

• **Associate Professor, Thomas Wimarck:** Human Geography, Uppsala University | thomas.wimarck@kultgeog.uu.se | +46 18 471 73 77

Colleague on “Neighborhood revisited” project, co-authoring a paper under revision

• **Professor Pieter Bevelander,** Professor of Human Geography, Malmö University | pieter.bevelander@mau.se | 040-665 73 43

My PhD opponent.

Co-applicant on a project proposal previously submitted to RJ, together with me and other collaborators; the project is currently under development.